
★ PART 1 — MASTER DOCUMENT (Modules 01–07)

Page-break markers included exactly as requested.

DESIGN-LED: FULL CURRICULUM (2026 EDITION)

Warm clarity with a backbone. Grounded. Human. Commercially fluent. Emotionally intelligent.

INTRODUCTION

Design-Led is a program about judgment — the kind that shapes products, services, teams, and organisations.

It's not a design course. It's a thinking course.

It's about how to see clearly, decide wisely, and act intentionally in complex systems full of humans, constraints, politics, and possibility.

Across 13 half-day modules, participants learn the disciplines that sit underneath good design decisions: research, analysis, strategy, product thinking, service design, AI-era interaction patterns, data literacy, and the craft of making sense.

This curriculum is written in a tone that reflects how you teach:

warm clarity with a backbone — grounded, human, commercially fluent, emotionally intelligent, with a light wink.

Each module begins with a short narrative framing, followed by structured, slide-ready content.

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MODULE 01 — FOUNDATIONS

Design has always been about judgment. AI just made that harder to ignore.

Framing

Most teams think design is the part where the pixels get pretty.

But the real work — the work that changes outcomes — happens long before a screen exists.

Design is the discipline of making good decisions in messy, human systems.

This module sets the foundation for everything that follows.

Core Claim

Design is not a craft function. It's a thinking discipline.

The hybrid designer — part strategist, researcher, director, collaborator — is the role organisations need most right now.

Session Flow

Beat	Content
OPEN	Meridian Bank shipped a new onboarding flow. On time. Under budget. Drop-off at step 2 was 34% worse. Nobody had asked why.
CONTEXT	What design is not (craft, aesthetics, decoration). What design is (the discipline of making good decisions).
CONCEPT 01	The three lenses: Desirable / Viable / Feasible. Every decision lives in all three.
QUICK HIT 01	"What word comes to mind when someone says 'I'm a designer'?"
CONCEPT 02	AI changes the calculus — speeds up execution, raises the stakes on judgment.
ACTIVITY 01	Score a past project against the three lenses. Where did the lens get skipped?

CONCEPT 03 The six design mindsets: empathy first, systems thinking, bias to action, embrace ambiguity, iterate always, communicate intent.

QUICK HIT 02 “Which mindset is hardest to practise in your organisation?”

ACTIVITY 02 Reframe the Meridian Bank brief. Write the question they should have asked.

CLOSE One takeaway. One question still open. Next: Research.

Participants Leave Able To

- Articulate what design actually is in language that lands with non-designers
- Apply the three lenses to any product decision
- Name the mindset gap in their organisation

Methods

Three lenses · design mindsets · reframing · reflective practice

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MODULE 02 — RESEARCH

The most expensive thing you can build is the wrong thing.

Framing

Research isn't a phase. It's a habit.

Teams that talk to real users every week make better decisions than teams that run a big research sprint at kickoff and then fly blind for six months.

This module teaches the discipline of staying close to reality.

Core Claim

Research is a weekly habit that runs alongside delivery.

The team that talks to users regularly outperforms the team that relies on assumptions.

Session Flow

Beat	Content
OPEN	Luma Health built a medication reminder feature. Zero bugs. 4% adoption. They'd never spoken to a patient.
CONTEXT	Two traps: assumption (designing for yourself) and past experience (reaching for last project's answer).
CONCEPT 01	Qual vs quant. Continuous discovery. Hypothesis before method.
QUICK HIT 01	"What's the last assumption your team shipped without validating?"
CONCEPT 02	One-on-one interviews — structure, question shape, what to avoid.
ACTIVITY 01	Write five interview questions for Luma Health. No yes/no. No solutions. One emotional/contextual probe.
DEBRIEF	"Which question had the solution hidden inside it?"
CONCEPT 03	The seven biases: Hawthorn, Availability, Incentives, Note-taking, Novice/Expert, Telescope, Primacy.
QUICK HIT 02	"Which bias affects your team's research most — and does leadership know?"
ACTIVITY 02	Spot and fix four bad Luma Health interview questions. Rewrite them properly.
CLOSE	One takeaway. One question. Next: Analysis.

Participants Leave Able To

- Run a one-on-one interview that generates real insight
- Write open questions that don't embed the solution
- Name the biases affecting their team's research

Methods

Interviewing · question design · bias identification · continuous discovery

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MODULE 03 — ANALYSIS

Data doesn't speak for itself. Someone has to make sense of it.

Framing

Most research fails at the analysis step — not because the data wasn't there, but because nobody had a method for making sense of it.

This module teaches the discipline of turning raw data into insight, and insight into opportunity.

Core Claim

Affinity mapping, thematic clustering, and insight framing are learnable skills — and they're what turn a wall of sticky notes into a design decision.

Session Flow

Beat	Content
OPEN	A team ran twelve interviews. The research sat untouched for three weeks. The decision was made without it.
CONTEXT	Why analysis gets skipped: time pressure, no method, no owner. The four-step arc: collect → sort → cluster → insight.
CONCEPT 01	Affinity mapping — open vs closed sorting. How to run it with a team.
QUICK HIT 01	"Has your team ever done research nobody acted on? What happened to it?"
CONCEPT 02	What is an insight? A deep truth drawn from behaviour — not an observation.
ACTIVITY 01	Sort Luma Health interview quotes into clusters. Name each cluster with what it <i>tells you</i> , not what it contains.
DEBRIEF	"What surprised you? What did you find you weren't looking for?"

CONCEPT 03 Lean personas. How Might We reframing — turning insight into opportunity.

QUICK HIT 02 “Write one HMW for the cluster you found most surprising.”

ACTIVITY 02 Write three insights. Turn each into a HMW. Prioritise one.

CLOSE One takeaway. One question. Next: Strategy.

Participants Leave Able To

- Run an affinity mapping session
- Distinguish between an observation and an insight
- Write a How Might We that opens the design space

Methods

Affinity mapping · thematic clustering · insight writing · lean personas · HMW reframing

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MODULE 04 — STRATEGY

Good design decisions are also good business decisions.

Framing

Most designers were never taught how a business works — not because they can’t learn it, but because nobody ever invited them into the room where commercial decisions get made.

This module closes that gap.

It gives designers the tools to speak the language of strategy, understand why a product exists commercially, and make design decisions that move the metrics that matter.

When designers understand the business model, they stop being “the people who make it pretty” and become “the people who make it work.”

Core Claim

Designers who understand the business model make better design decisions.

The Business Model Canvas and Value Proposition Canvas are not MBA tools — they're clarity tools.

Session Flow

Beat	Content
OPEN	Meridian Bank wants a new digital savings product. The brief: "Make it engaging." Nobody has answered who it's for, what problem it solves, or whether it's viable.
CONTEXT	The gap between design and strategy. Why designers end up styling solutions to problems nobody defined.
CONCEPT 01	Business Model Canvas — nine blocks, one page. How design decisions show up in each block.
QUICK HIT 01	"Could you sketch the business model of the product you're working on — all nine blocks?"
CONCEPT 02	Value Proposition Canvas — customer jobs, pains, gains → products, pain relievers, gain creators.
ACTIVITY 01	Fill in the Value Proposition Canvas for Meridian's savings product.
DEBRIEF	"Where was the canvas hardest to fill — and what does that tell you about the brief?"
CONCEPT 03	Jobs to Be Done — customers hire products to make progress. How to reframe a brief around the job.
QUICK HIT 02	"What job is your product currently hired to do — and is it doing it?"
ACTIVITY 02	Write a one-page design recommendation that makes the commercial case.
CLOSE	One takeaway. One question. Next: Product.

Participants Leave Able To

- Read and sketch a Business Model Canvas
- Connect design decisions to business outcomes
- Write a design recommendation that makes a commercial case

Methods

Business Model Canvas · Value Proposition Canvas · Jobs to Be Done · commercial case writing

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MODULE 05 — PRODUCT

Empowered teams own outcomes. Feature teams own roadmaps. Know the difference.

Framing

Most teams are still operating like feature factories — handed a list of outputs and told to make them beautiful.

But empowered product teams work differently: they own the problem, not the solution. Designers in this model need to show up with a point of view on outcomes, not just a Figma file.

This module teaches designers how to think like product partners — not service providers.

Core Claim

The product trio (PM + designer + tech lead) owns the problem. Designers must connect their decisions to outcomes, not outputs.

Session Flow

Beat	Content
OPEN	Cargo's design team built a beautiful tracking dashboard. The metric they were meant to move didn't shift. Nobody connected the feature to the outcome.

CONTEXT	Feature teams vs empowered teams. Missionaries vs mercenaries. Why most teams build output instead of pursuing outcomes.
CONCEPT 01	The empowered product model — what each role owns. How design's accountability shifts.
QUICK HIT 01	"Is your team given problems to solve — or features to build?"
CONCEPT 02	Outcome vs output. North Star metrics. Opportunity Solution Trees (OST).
ACTIVITY 01	For Cargo's tracking problem: define the outcome → map opportunities → sketch solutions.
DEBRIEF	"Which branch felt strongest — and what would you need to learn to validate it?"
CONCEPT 03	Discovery vs delivery — running them in parallel. What design owns in that model.
QUICK HIT 02	"What's the nearest equivalent to continuous discovery in your current way of working?"
ACTIVITY 02	Write a one-pager for Cargo's trio: outcome → opportunity → experiment → metric.
CLOSE	One takeaway. One question. Next: DevEx & Product Intelligence.

Participants Leave Able To

- Articulate the difference between empowered and feature teams
- Connect design decisions to outcome metrics
- Sketch an Opportunity Solution Tree

Methods

Empowered product model · product trio · OST · discovery/delivery in parallel

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MODULE 06 — DEVEX & PRODUCT INTELLIGENCE

Internal tools are real products. Treat them like it.

Framing

Internal tools shape how teams work — and how they feel about their work.

When internal tools are clunky, unclear, or built without research, teams build workarounds, lose trust, and slow down.

Developer experience (DevEx) is a design problem.

And without product intelligence — the discipline of turning data into decisions — organisations end up making choices based on gut feel dressed up as dashboards.

This module teaches designers how to bring rigour to internal tools and internal data.

Core Claim

Developer experience is a design problem.

Product intelligence is a design problem.

Internal tools deserve the same rigour as external products.

Session Flow

Beat	Content
OPEN	Foundry shipped a new deployment tool. Engineers used it because they were told to — then built workarounds.
CONTEXT	Who developer users are. Their mental models. Their tolerance for complexity — and intolerance for friction.
CONCEPT 01	DevEx design principles — documentation as UX, API design as IA, error messages as conversation.
QUICK HIT 01	“Has your team ever shipped an internal tool nobody used?”
CONCEPT 02	Product intelligence — data → insight → hypothesis → experiment → decision. Instrumentation before build.

- ACTIVITY 01** For Foundry's tool: define three intelligence questions. What data answers them? What to instrument?
- DEBRIEF** "Where in the intelligence loop does your team break down?"
- CONCEPT 03** Internal product design — research with engineers, dogfooding vs real testing, investment rationale.
- QUICK HIT 02** "What internal tool would benefit most from a design review — and who must you convince?"
- ACTIVITY 02** Sketch a research plan for Foundry's next internal tool.
- CLOSE** One takeaway. One question. Next: Service Design.

Participants Leave Able To

- Apply design thinking to internal tools
- Define what to instrument before building
- Run the product intelligence loop

Methods

DevEx principles · instrumentation · product intelligence loop · internal research

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MODULE 07 — SERVICE DESIGN

Most experiences fail in the back stage, not the front.

Integrated with the new Service Blueprinting pack.

Framing

Every customer experience is the visible surface of a much larger system.

The call that goes unanswered, the form that doesn't match the policy, the staff member who

doesn't know what another team promised — these aren't people problems.
They're system problems.

Service design is how we make the invisible visible.
It's how we see the whole system, not just the screen.

This module uses your fully rewritten **Service Blueprinting pack** as the core teaching asset.

Core Claim

Service design maps the whole system — front to back — so you can see where it's breaking and design your way out.

Session Flow

(Aligned to the rewritten Blueprinting pack)

Beat	Content
OPEN	Meridian Bank's mortgage app has a 4.7 star rating — and a 38% drop-out at document upload because the back stage still requires fax.
CONTEXT	What service design is. The five problems a blueprint cracks open: upstream causes, broken experiences, backstage inefficiencies, silo breakdowns, fuzzy ownership.
CONCEPT 01	Where blueprinting fits — journey map family. Frame before you map: scenario, customer, known pain, learning goal.
CONCEPT 02	Anatomy — five lanes, three lines. Above vs below the line.
QUICK HIT 01	"Name one step your customer sees — and what's happening backstage to deliver it."
CONCEPT 03	Workshop format: diverge → converge. AI assists; humans validate.
ACTIVITY 01	Map the front stage of Meridian's mortgage scenario.
DEBRIEF	"What did you assume was smooth that another lane showed was broken?"
CONCEPT 04	Mining the blueprint — critical moments, tactical vs strategic fixes, multi-channel complexity, staff as actors.

QUICK HIT 02 “Where does your front/back stage handoff most often fail?”

ACTIVITY 02 Add back stage + support processes. Identify two critical moments. Classify one tactical, one strategic.

CLOSE One takeaway. One question. Next: Information Architecture.

Participants Leave Able To

- Run a service blueprinting workshop
- Identify where a service breaks in the back stage
- Prioritise fixes as tactical or strategic

Methods

Service blueprinting · journey map family · diverge/converge · AI-augmented synthesis · critical moment identification

Perfect, Jacinta — here is **PART 2 of the master document**, containing **Modules 08–13**, with **page-break markers included**, in one clean block you can copy/paste straight into Word or Google Docs.

This is the second and final half of your full curriculum.

★ PART 2 — MASTER DOCUMENT (Modules 08–13)

Page-break markers included exactly as requested.

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MODULE 08 — INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

Structure is invisible until it breaks.

Framing

Most people only notice information architecture when it fails — when they can't find the thing they know must be there, when the navigation feels like a maze, when the system's mental model doesn't match their own.

IA is the quiet discipline that makes everything else feel effortless.

And now, with AI agents doing tasks on our behalf, the old rules don't fully apply.

This module teaches both the classical foundations and the emerging patterns.

Core Claim

Information architecture is the design of structure — how things are organised, labelled, and found.

Agent experiences introduce a new IA discipline: designing for delegation, not navigation.

Session Flow

Beat	Content
OPEN	Orbit added 400 new titles. Engagement dropped. The content was there — the structure wasn't.
CONTEXT	What IA is. The four components: organisation, labelling, navigation, search. Mental models.
CONCEPT 01	Classical IA methods — card sorting (open vs closed), tree testing, navigation principles.

- QUICK HIT 01** “Name a product where the navigation just works — and one where it absolutely doesn’t.”
- CONCEPT 02** Agent IA — when the user delegates instead of navigates. New questions: visibility, interruption, trust.
- ACTIVITY 01** Card sort 24 Orbit features. Open sort. Name categories. Compare with a partner.
- DEBRIEF** “Where did you disagree — and what does that reveal about mental models?”
- CONCEPT 03** Interruption model for agents — when the agent pauses, asks, explains, or hands back control.
- QUICK HIT 02** “For Foundry’s deployment agent — what are the three moments it must interrupt the engineer?”
- ACTIVITY 02** Design the interruption model. Map the flow. Write what the agent says at each point.
- CLOSE** One takeaway. One question. Next: Conversational UI.

Participants Leave Able To

- Run a card sort and interpret results
- Design navigation based on mental models
- Map interruption points and trust signals for an AI agent

Methods

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MODULE 09 — CONVERSATIONAL UI

When there’s no button to press, language is the design.

Framing

Conversational interfaces remove all the scaffolding designers usually rely on — no layout, no hierarchy, no visual cues.

Every response becomes a design decision.

And when the context is sensitive (health, finance, safety), the stakes are high.

This module teaches the craft of designing conversations that feel natural, trustworthy, and human.

Core Claim

Dialogue design is IA, copywriting, and interaction design collapsed into one.

Tone isn’t optional — it’s the interface.

Session Flow

Beat	Content
OPEN	Luma Health launched a chatbot. Technically correct. Emotionally off. 60% drop-off after the second response.
CONTEXT	When conversation UI is the right choice — and when it isn’t.
CONCEPT 01	Dialogue design principles — turn-taking, response length, reading level, persona.

- QUICK HIT 01** “Have you ever spoken to an AI that felt natural? What made it feel that way?”
- CONCEPT 02** Conversation flow design — happy path, branching, unexpected inputs, error recovery.
- ACTIVITY 01** Write a dialogue flow for a patient asking about medication dose. Happy path + one branch + fallback.
- DEBRIEF** “Where did your dialogue break — and how did you design your way out?”
- CONCEPT 03** Persona design — voice, tone, character. High-stakes vs low-stakes contexts. Disclosure.
- QUICK HIT 02** “When should Luma’s bot disclose it’s AI — and how should it say it?”
- ACTIVITY 02** Design three error states and three recovery responses. Write the actual copy.
- CLOSE** One takeaway. One question. Next: AI-Era Design.

Participants Leave Able To

- Write a conversation flow with branching and recovery
- Design a bot persona appropriate to the context
- Handle disclosure and fallback in high-stakes scenarios

Methods

Dialogue flow design · persona design · error recovery · fallback design · disclosure design

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MODULE 10 — AI-ERA DESIGN

AI changes what designers build. It doesn't change why.

Framing

AI introduces a new class of design problems: uncertainty, confidence, explainability, trust, and the handoff between AI and human.

These aren't technical problems — they're interaction design problems.
This module teaches designers how to design for probabilistic systems in a way that feels trustworthy, transparent, and human.

Core Claim

AI outputs are probabilistic, not deterministic.
Designers must shape how uncertainty is communicated, how trust is built, and how handoffs happen.

Session Flow

Beat	Content
OPEN	Meridian's AI loan advisor is accurate 87% of the time. The 13% failure shows up weeks later in an email from another team.
CONTEXT	What changes when AI is in the product: uncertainty, trust, disclosure, error types.
CONCEPT 01	Transparency spectrum — from black box to explainable. Confidence UI. Showing uncertainty without alarming users.

QUICK HIT 01 “Name a product that uses AI — does it tell you when it’s uncertain?”

CONCEPT 02 Trust patterns — progressive disclosure, reasoning previews, graceful failure, handoff moments.

ACTIVITY 01 Design a trust signal for the loan rate recommendation.

DEBRIEF “What did you choose to show — and what did you choose to hide?”

CONCEPT 03 Agent UX patterns — progress visibility, interruption, approval, audit trails. Ethical design: bias, accessibility, incomplete data.

QUICK HIT 02 “In Meridian’s advisor — who is responsible when the AI is wrong?”

ACTIVITY 02 Map the handoff moments. Write what the interface says at each one.

CLOSE One takeaway. One question. Next: Data & Decisions.

Participants Leave Able To

- Design trust signals for AI-generated content
- Map AI → human handoff moments
- Apply ethical design principles

Methods

AI transparency · confidence UI · trust signals · agent UX · ethical design

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MODULE 11 — DATA & DECISIONS

Leaders don't need more data. They need to trust the data they have.

Framing

Most organisations are drowning in dashboards and starving for insight.

Leaders don't need 47 slides of numbers — they need clarity, signal, and confidence.

Data quality is a design problem.

And when AI generates insights, the interface must help humans understand what to trust and what to question.

Core Claim

Information design shapes decision-making.

A dashboard that shows everything helps no one decide anything.

Session Flow

Beat	Content
OPEN	Meridian's execs meet weekly with a 47-slide data pack. Decisions still get made on gut feel.
CONTEXT	What leaders need vs what they ask for. Reports vs dashboards. Tufte's principles.
CONCEPT 01	Dashboard design — hierarchy, primary metric, context, anomaly detection.
QUICK HIT 01	"What dashboard do you use — and what decision does it actually help you make?"

CONCEPT 02 Data quality as UX — trust signals, recency, methodology, uncertainty.

ACTIVITY 01 Critique a bad Meridian dashboard. Identify noise vs signal.

DEBRIEF “What’s the one number that actually matters for the decision?”

CONCEPT 03 Designing for AI-generated insights — confidence, reasoning, ‘so what?’ layer.

QUICK HIT 02 “What metric does your leadership team consistently misread — and why?”

ACTIVITY 02 Redesign one panel to support one decision.

CLOSE One takeaway. One question. Next: Judgment in Practice.

Participants Leave Able To

- Design dashboards that support decisions
- Communicate uncertainty clearly
- Shape AI-generated insights into actionable guidance

Methods

Information design · trust signals · uncertainty UI · decision-support design

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MODULE 12 — JUDGMENT IN PRACTICE

Tools matter. Judgment decides.

Framing

By this point in the program, participants have learned the disciplines: research, analysis, strategy, product, service design, IA, conversational UI, AI-era design, data literacy.

But tools don't make decisions — people do.

And in real organisations, judgment is shaped by constraints, politics, incentives, fear, confidence, and culture.

This module is about the *human* side of design judgment:

how to see clearly, decide wisely, and act with integrity in complex systems.

Core Claim

Good judgment is the designer's real superpower.

It's the ability to see the system, hold competing truths, and choose the next right move.

Session Flow

Beat	Content
OPEN	A team at Meridian had perfect research, a clear insight, and a validated concept — and still shipped the wrong thing because the loudest stakeholder won.
CONTEXT	Judgment as a practice: clarity, courage, curiosity, and constraint awareness.
CONCEPT 01	The four forces that shape judgment: incentives, evidence, emotion, and power.
QUICK HIT 01	"Which of these four forces shapes decisions most in your organisation?"

CONCEPT 02 Decision hygiene — separating facts from interpretations, assumptions from evidence, preferences from principles.

ACTIVITY 01 Reconstruct a past decision: what was known, unknown, assumed, feared, incentivised?

DEBRIEF “What changed when you separated fact from interpretation?”

CONCEPT 03 Judgment traps: premature convergence, overconfidence, consensus theatre, analysis paralysis.

QUICK HIT 02 “Which trap does your team fall into most often?”

ACTIVITY 02 Write a decision brief for a current project: the decision, the evidence, the risks, the trade-offs, the principle guiding the choice.

CLOSE One takeaway. One question. Next: Capstone.

Participants Leave Able To

- Identify the forces shaping judgment in their organisation
- Practise decision hygiene
- Write a clear, principled decision brief

Methods

Decision hygiene · judgment traps · decision briefs · reflective practice

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MODULE 13 — CAPSTONE / INTEGRATION

Design is a discipline. Integration is the skill.

Framing

The final module brings everything together.

Participants integrate the full stack of design-led skills — research, analysis, strategy, product, service design, AI-era patterns, data literacy, and judgment — into a single, coherent practice.

This is where the program stops being a set of modules and becomes a way of working.

Core Claim

Integration is the real skill.

Design-led teams don't apply methods in isolation — they combine them to make better decisions, faster.

Session Flow

Beat	Content
OPEN	Three teams at Meridian tackled the same problem. Each used different methods. Only one team integrated across disciplines — and they solved the root cause.
CONTEXT	The integration challenge: connecting research → insight → strategy → product → service → data → judgment.
CONCEPT 01	The Design-Led Loop — a repeatable pattern for complex problem-solving.

QUICK HIT 01	“Which part of the loop is your team strongest in — and which part do you skip?”
CONCEPT 02	Cross-discipline synthesis — how to combine evidence, opportunity, feasibility, and risk.
ACTIVITY 01	Capstone challenge: teams choose a real organisational problem and run a compressed version of the loop.
DEBRIEF	“Where did your team get stuck — and what unlocked it?”
CONCEPT 03	Designing your practice — how to bring Design-Led into your team’s weekly rhythm.
QUICK HIT 02	“What’s one ritual you’ll take back to your team next week?”
ACTIVITY 02	Write your Design-Led operating manual: principles, rituals, methods, and commitments.
CLOSE	One takeaway. One commitment. One next step.

Participants Leave Able To

- Integrate multiple design disciplines into a coherent practice
- Apply the Design-Led Loop to real problems
- Build rituals that sustain design-led decision-making

Methods

Design-Led Loop · cross-discipline synthesis · capstone challenge · operating manual design

★ FURTHER READING & RESOURCES — BY MODULE

Design-Led: Full Curriculum (2026 Edition)

MODULE 01 — FOUNDATIONS

Theme: Design as judgment, not decoration.

Recommended:

- *The Design of Everyday Things* — Don Norman (foundational mental models)
 - *Creative Confidence* — Tom & David Kelley (mindsets, not methods)
 - *The Shape of Design* — Frank Chimero (design as meaning-making)
 - Article: “Design is the Business” — John Maeda
 - Talk: “The Art of the Start” — Guy Kawasaki (decision-making under uncertainty)
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MODULE 02 — RESEARCH

Theme: Research as a weekly habit.

Recommended:

- *Interviewing Users* — Steve Portigal
 - *Continuous Discovery Habits* — Teresa Torres
 - *Just Enough Research* — Erika Hall
 - Article: “The Mom Test” — Rob Fitzpatrick (asking non-leading questions)
 - Podcast: Dollars to Donuts (Portigal interviews researchers)
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MODULE 03 — ANALYSIS

Theme: Turning data into insight.

Recommended:

- *Observing the User Experience* — Goodman, Kuniavsky, Moed
 - *Think Like a UX Researcher* — Wilson & Parrish
 - Article: “Affinity Mapping 101” — Nielsen Norman Group
 - Talk: Indi Young on mental models and deep listening
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MODULE 04 — STRATEGY

Theme: Connecting design to commercial reality.

Recommended:

- *Business Model Generation* — Osterwalder & Pigneur
 - *Value Proposition Design* — Osterwalder et al.
 - *Competing Against Luck* — Clayton Christensen (Jobs to Be Done)
 - Article: “What Is Strategy?” — Michael Porter (HBR)
 - Podcast: Lenny’s Podcast — product strategy episodes
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MODULE 05 — PRODUCT

Theme: Empowered teams, outcomes over outputs.

Recommended:

- *Inspired* — Marty Cagan
 - *Empowered* — Marty Cagan
 - *Escaping the Build Trap* — Melissa Perri
 - Article: “Outcome Over Output” — Josh Seiden
 - Talk: Teresa Torres on Opportunity Solution Trees
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MODULE 06 — DEVEX & PRODUCT INTELLIGENCE

Theme: Internal tools as real products.

Recommended:

- *The Developer Experience Book* — Matthew Skelton (DX patterns)
 - Article: “Developer Experience: What It Is and Why It Matters” — GitHub
 - Article: “The Product Intelligence Loop” — Mixpanel
 - Talk: Charity Majors on observability and internal tooling
 - Podcast: Software Engineering Daily — DevEx episodes
-

MODULE 07 — SERVICE DESIGN

Theme: Seeing the whole system.

Recommended:

- *This Is Service Design Doing* — Stickdorn, Lawrence, Hormess, Schneider
 - *Service Design: From Insight to Implementation* — Polaine, Løvlie, Reason
 - Article: “Blueprinting: The Hidden Architecture of Services” — NN/g
 - Talk: Lou Downe — “Good Services”
 - Your own **Service Blueprinting Pack** (primary resource)
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MODULE 08 — INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

Theme: Structure, mental models, and agent-era IA.

Recommended:

- *Information Architecture for the Web and Beyond* — Rosenfeld, Morville, Arango
- *Everyday Information Architecture* — Lisa Maria Marquis
- Article: “Card Sorting: When, Why, How” — NN/g

- Talk: Abby Covert — “How to Make Sense of Any Mess”
 - Article: “Designing for Agents” — Google UX
-

MODULE 09 — CONVERSATIONAL UI

Theme: Language as interface.

Recommended:

- *Designing Voice User Interfaces* — Cathy Pearl
 - *Conversational Design* — Erika Hall
 - Article: “Principles of Bot Design” — Google
 - Talk: “Designing for Conversation” — Erika Hall
 - Podcast: Voicebot.ai
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MODULE 10 — AI-ERA DESIGN

Theme: Trust, uncertainty, explainability.

Recommended:

- *Human-Centered AI* — Ben Shneiderman
 - *The Alignment Problem* — Brian Christian
 - Article: “Explainable AI: A Guide for Designers” — IBM
 - Article: “Confidence UI Patterns” — Google
 - Talk: “Designing for AI” — Josh Clark
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MODULE 11 — DATA & DECISIONS

Theme: Information design for clarity and action.

Recommended:

- *The Visual Display of Quantitative Information* — Edward Tufte
- *Storytelling with Data* — Cole Nussbaumer Knaflic

- Article: “Dashboard Design Principles” — NN/g
 - Talk: “The Beauty of Data Visualization” — David McCandless
 - Podcast: Data Stories
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MODULE 12 — JUDGMENT IN PRACTICE

Theme: Decision hygiene, clarity, courage.

Recommended:

- *Noise* — Daniel Kahneman, Olivier Sibony, Cass Sunstein
 - *Thinking in Bets* — Annie Duke
 - *The Art of Thinking Clearly* — Rolf Dobelli
 - Article: “Decision Hygiene” — Olivier Sibony
 - Talk: Annie Duke — “How to Decide”
-

MODULE 13 — CAPSTONE / INTEGRATION

Theme: Integration as the real skill.

Recommended:

- *Range* — David Epstein (breadth as advantage)
 - *Systems Thinking for Social Change* — David Peter Stroh
 - Article: “The Double Diamond Isn’t Enough” — Dan Nessler
 - Talk: “The Power of Integrative Thinking” — Roger Martin
 - Podcast: Farnam Street — multidisciplinary thinking
-

SLIDES

Brilliant — we're moving into **deck production mode**.

Before I generate 13 full decks (which is a *lot* of content), I'm going to produce **Module 01 as a complete slide deck** in your chosen tone and structure so you can confirm the format before I roll it out across all modules.

You already chose:

- **Deck style:** Signature Jacinta
- **Tone:** Warm clarity with a backbone
- **Structure:** Slide-ready (titles, bullets, clean, scannable)
- **No prose**
- **Occasional Jacinta-isms**
- **Page-break markers not needed for decks**

Here we go.

MODULE 01 — FOUNDATIONS

Slide-Ready Deck (Signature Jacinta Style)

Slide 1 — Title

FOUNDATIONS

Design has always been about judgment.

Slide 2 — What This Module Is About

- Design as a thinking discipline
- Why judgment matters more than craft
- How AI raises the stakes
- The six design mindsets
- The three lenses for decision-making

Slide 3 — The Opening Story

Meridian Bank shipped a new onboarding flow.

- On time
- Under budget
- Beautiful screens
- **Drop-off at step 2 increased by 34%**
- Nobody had asked *why*

→ This is what happens when design = decoration, not decision-making.

Slide 4 — What Design Is Not

- Not “making it pretty”
 - Not “the UI team”
 - Not “the people who do Figma”
 - Not decoration
 - Not the last step before build
-

Slide 5 — What Design Is

- The discipline of making good decisions
- In messy, human systems
- With incomplete information
- Under constraints
- In collaboration with others

Design = judgment.

Slide 6 — The Three Lenses

Every design decision must pass through:

- **Desirable** — Do humans want it?

- **Viable** — Does the business sustain it?
- **Feasible** — Can we build and operate it?

Skip a lens → create a problem.

Slide 7 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“What word comes to mind when someone says *‘I’m a designer’*?”

(Use this to surface assumptions + stereotypes.)

Slide 8 — Why AI Changes Everything

- Execution is now fast
 - Craft is increasingly automated
 - Output is cheap
 - **Judgment is the differentiator**
 - Teams who can’t think clearly will drown in velocity
-

Slide 9 — Activity: Score a Past Project

Score one of your recent projects across the three lenses:

- Desirable
- Viable
- Feasible

Where did you over-index?

Where did you skip?

Slide 10 — The Six Design Mindsets

- Empathy first
- Systems thinking

- Bias to action
- Embrace ambiguity
- Iterate always
- Communicate intent

These are the muscles of judgment.

Slide 11 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“Which mindset is hardest to practise in your organisation?”

(Expect: systems thinking + communicate intent.)

Slide 12 — Activity: Reframe the Brief

Original brief:

“Fix Meridian’s onboarding drop-off.”

Rewrite the question they *should* have asked:

- What’s happening at step 2?
 - What’s the user trying to do?
 - What’s the system doing behind the scenes?
 - What’s the real problem?
-

Slide 13 — The Real Work of Design

- Seeing clearly
 - Asking better questions
 - Understanding the system
 - Making principled decisions
 - Communicating intent
 - Holding the tension between lenses
-

Slide 14 — Close

One takeaway:

What landed for you?

One question:

What's still unclear?

Next module:

RESEARCH — The most expensive thing you can build is the wrong thing.

MODULE 01 — FOUNDATIONS

Theme: Design as judgment, not decoration.

Recommended:

- *The Design of Everyday Things* — Don Norman (foundational mental models)
- *Creative Confidence* — Tom & David Kelley (mindsets, not methods)
- *The Shape of Design* — Frank Chimero (design as meaning-making)
- Article: “Design is the Business” — John Maeda
- Talk: “The Art of the Start” — Guy Kawasaki (decision-making under uncertainty)

Perfect — I'll produce **slide-ready decks for Modules 02 and 03**, each with a “Further Reading & Resources” slide at the end, exactly in your Signature Jacinta tone.

Same structure as Module 01:

- Slide titles
- Clean bullets
- Optional facilitator notes
- No prose
- Human, grounded, commercially fluent
- “Jacinta-isms” where it helps
- **Final slide = curated resources for that module**

Let's go.

★ MODULE 02 — RESEARCH

Slide-Ready Deck (Signature Jacinta Style + Resources)

Slide 1 — Title

RESEARCH

The most expensive thing you can build is the wrong thing.

Slide 2 — What This Module Is About

- Research as a weekly habit
 - Talking to humans early and often
 - Asking questions that reveal truth, not confirmation
 - Avoiding the seven biases
 - Turning assumptions into learning
-

Slide 3 — Opening Story

Luma Health built a medication reminder feature.

- Zero bugs
- Beautiful UI
- 4% adoption
- They never spoke to a patient

→ **Research is not a phase. It's a habit.**

Slide 4 — Two Research Traps

- **Assumption:** designing for yourself
- **Past experience:** reaching for last project's answer
- Both feel efficient
- Both create blind spots

Slide 5 — What Research Actually Is

- A weekly conversation with reality
 - A way to reduce risk
 - A way to understand context, emotion, constraints
 - A way to test assumptions
 - A way to shape better decisions
-

Slide 6 — Qual vs Quant

Qual:

- Why people behave the way they do
- Context, emotion, workarounds

Quant:

- What's happening at scale
- Patterns, anomalies, trends

You need both.

Slide 7 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“What's the last assumption your team shipped without validating?”

Slide 8 — Interviewing 101

Good interviews:

- Open questions
- No solutions embedded
- No leading language
- One question at a time

- Silence is a tool
-

Slide 9 — Activity: Write 5 Questions

Write five questions for Luma Health:

- No yes/no
 - No solutions
 - One emotional probe
 - One contextual probe
-

Slide 10 — Debrief

Ask:

“Which question had the solution hidden inside it?”

(They always find one.)

Slide 11 — The Seven Biases

- Hawthorn
- Availability
- Incentives
- Note-taking
- Novice/Expert
- Telescope
- Primacy

Bias isn't a flaw — it's a factor.

Slide 12 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“Which bias affects your team's research most — and does leadership know?”

Slide 13 — Activity: Fix the Questions

Rewrite four bad Luma Health questions:

- Remove assumptions
 - Remove solutions
 - Add context
 - Add emotion
-

Slide 14 — Close

One takeaway:

What landed?

One question:

What's still unclear?

Next:

ANALYSIS — Data doesn't speak for itself. Someone has to make sense of it.

Slide 15 — Further Reading & Resources

Books

- *Interviewing Users* — Steve Portigal
- *Continuous Discovery Habits* — Teresa Torres
- *Just Enough Research* — Erika Hall

Articles

- "The Mom Test" — Rob Fitzpatrick
- NN/g: "How to Ask Better Questions"

Talks / Podcasts

- Dollars to Donuts — Steve Portigal
- Teresa Torres on continuous discovery

★ MODULE 03 — ANALYSIS

Slide-Ready Deck (Signature Jacinta Style + Resources)

Slide 1 — Title

ANALYSIS

Data doesn't speak for itself. Someone has to make sense of it.

Slide 2 — What This Module Is About

- Making sense of raw data
 - Affinity mapping
 - Thematic clustering
 - Writing real insights
 - Turning insights into opportunities
-

Slide 3 — Opening Story

A team ran **12 interviews**.

The research sat untouched for **3 weeks**.

The decision was made without it.

→ **Research without analysis is theatre.**

Slide 4 — Why Analysis Gets Skipped

- Time pressure
- No method
- No owner
- Fear of being wrong

- “We already know the answer”
-

Slide 5 — The Four-Step Arc

1. Collect
2. Sort
3. Cluster
4. Insight

Simple. Hard. Transformational.

Slide 6 — Affinity Mapping

- Open vs closed sorting
 - Group by meaning, not topic
 - Name clusters by what they *tell you*
 - Not what they *contain*
-

Slide 7 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“Has your team ever done research nobody acted on? What happened to it?”

Slide 8 — Activity: Sort the Quotes

Sort Luma Health interview quotes:

- Group by meaning
 - Name the cluster
 - Don’t overthink it
-

Slide 9 — Debrief

Ask:

“What surprised you?

What did you find you weren’t looking for?”

Surprise = insight.

Slide 10 — What Is an Insight?

An insight is:

- A deep truth
- Drawn from behaviour
- That explains *why* something is happening

Not:

- An observation
 - A quote
 - A theme
-

Slide 11 — Lean Personas

- Based on behaviour, not demographics
 - Capture goals, constraints, context
 - Lightweight, living, useful
-

Slide 12 — HMW Reframing

Turn insights into opportunity:

How Might We...

- Open the space
 - Remove assumptions
 - Invite multiple solutions
-

Slide 13 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“Write one HMW for the cluster you found most surprising.”

Slide 14 — Activity: Insight → HMW

Write:

- 3 insights
 - 3 HMWs
 - Prioritise one
-

Slide 15 — Close

One takeaway:

What landed?

One question:

What's still unclear?

Next:

STRATEGY — Good design decisions are also good business decisions.

Slide 16 — Further Reading & Resources

Books

- *Observing the User Experience* — Goodman, Kuniavsky, Moed
- *Think Like a UX Researcher* — Wilson & Parrish

Articles

- NN/g: “Affinity Mapping 101”
- “What Is an Insight?” — UX Collective

Talks

- Indi Young — deep listening & mental models
-
-

MODULE 04 — STRATEGY

Slide-Ready Deck (Signature Jacinta Style + Resources)

Slide 1 — Title

STRATEGY

Good design decisions are also good business decisions.

Slide 2 — What This Module Is About

- Connecting design to commercial reality
 - Understanding the business model
 - Value Proposition Canvas
 - Jobs to Be Done
 - Making the commercial case for design
-

Slide 3 — Opening Story

Meridian Bank wants a new digital savings product.

- Brief: “Make it engaging.”
- No clarity on:
 - Who it’s for
 - What problem it solves
 - Whether it’s viable

→ **Design without strategy = styling.**

Slide 4 — Why Strategy Matters

- Design decisions affect revenue
 - Design decisions affect cost
 - Design decisions affect risk
 - Designers need commercial literacy
 - Strategy = clarity
-

Slide 5 — Business Model Canvas

Nine blocks, one page:

- Customer segments
- Value propositions
- Channels
- Customer relationships
- Revenue streams
- Key activities
- Key resources
- Key partners
- Cost structure

Design touches all nine.

Slide 6 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“Could you sketch the business model of the product you’re working on — all nine blocks?”

Slide 7 — Value Proposition Canvas

Two sides:

Customer:

- Jobs
- Pains
- Gains

Product:

- Pain relievers
 - Gain creators
 - Features
-

Slide 8 — Activity: Fill the Canvas

For Meridian's savings product:

- Identify customer jobs
 - Identify pains
 - Identify gains
 - Map product responses
-

Slide 9 — Debrief

Ask:

“Which part of the canvas was hardest to fill — and what does that tell you about the brief?”

Slide 10 — Jobs to Be Done

Customers hire products to make progress.

Ask:

- What job is the customer trying to get done?
 - What's the struggle?
 - What's the workaround?
-

Slide 11 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“What job is your product currently hired to do — and is it doing it?”

Slide 12 — Activity: Write the Recommendation

Write a one-page design recommendation:

- The job
 - The opportunity
 - The commercial rationale
 - The design direction
-

Slide 13 — Close

One takeaway

One question

Next: PRODUCT — empowered teams own outcomes.

Slide 14 — Further Reading & Resources

Books

- *Business Model Generation* — Osterwalder & Pigneur
- *Value Proposition Design* — Osterwalder et al.
- *Competing Against Luck* — Clayton Christensen

Articles

- “What Is Strategy?” — Michael Porter (HBR)

Podcasts

- Lenny’s Podcast — product strategy episodes
-

MODULE 05 — PRODUCT

Slide-Ready Deck (Signature Jacinta Style + Resources)

Slide 1 — Title

PRODUCT

Empowered teams own outcomes. Feature teams own roadmaps.

Slide 2 — What This Module Is About

- Empowered product teams
 - Outcomes vs outputs
 - Product trio model
 - Opportunity Solution Trees
 - Discovery + delivery in parallel
-

Slide 3 — Opening Story

Cargo's design team built a beautiful tracking dashboard.
The metric they were meant to move didn't shift.

→ They built output, not outcome.

Slide 4 — Feature Teams vs Empowered Teams

Feature teams:

- Given solutions
- Measured on delivery
- No ownership

Empowered teams:

- Given problems
- Measured on outcomes
- Own decisions

Slide 5 — The Product Trio

- Product Manager
- Designer
- Tech Lead

Shared ownership of the problem.

Slide 6 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“Is your team given problems to solve — or features to build?”

Slide 7 — Outcomes vs Outputs

Output:

- Features
- Screens
- Tickets

Outcome:

- Behaviour change
 - Metric movement
 - Business impact
-

Slide 8 — Opportunity Solution Tree

Top → Outcome

Branches → Opportunities

Leaves → Solutions

Experiments → Evidence

Slide 9 — Activity: Map the OST

For Cargo's tracking problem:

- Define the outcome
 - Identify opportunities
 - Sketch solutions
-

Slide 10 — Debrief

Ask:

“Which branch felt strongest — and what would you need to learn to validate it?”

Slide 11 — Discovery vs Delivery

Discovery:

- Learn
- Test
- Reduce risk

Delivery:

- Build
- Ship
- Scale

Run them in parallel.

Slide 12 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“What's the nearest equivalent to continuous discovery in your current way of working?”

Slide 13 — Activity: Write the One-Pager

Include:

- Outcome
 - Opportunity
 - Experiment
 - Metric
-

Slide 14 — Close

One takeaway

One question

Next: DEVEX & PRODUCT INTELLIGENCE.

Slide 15 — Further Reading & Resources

Books

- *Inspired* — Marty Cagan
- *Empowered* — Marty Cagan
- *Escaping the Build Trap* — Melissa Perri

Articles

- “Outcome Over Output” — Josh Seiden

Talks

- Teresa Torres — Opportunity Solution Trees
-

MODULE 06 — DEVEX & PRODUCT INTELLIGENCE

Slide-Ready Deck (Signature Jacinta Style + Resources)

Slide 1 — Title

DEVEX & PRODUCT INTELLIGENCE

Internal tools are real products. Treat them like it.

Slide 2 — What This Module Is About

- Designing for developers
 - Internal tools as products
 - Product intelligence loop
 - Instrumentation before build
 - Research with engineers
-

Slide 3 — Opening Story

Foundry shipped a new deployment tool.

Engineers used it because they were told to —
then built workarounds.

→ Compliance ≠ adoption.

Slide 4 — Who Developer Users Are

- High tolerance for complexity
 - Low tolerance for friction
 - Strong mental models
 - Strong opinions
 - Deep context
-

Slide 5 — DevEx Design Principles

- Documentation = UX

- API design = IA
 - Error messages = conversation
 - Defaults = decisions
 - Speed = happiness
-

Slide 6 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“Has your team ever shipped an internal tool nobody used?”

Slide 7 — Product Intelligence Loop

1. Data
2. Insight
3. Hypothesis
4. Experiment
5. Decision

Instrument before you build.

Slide 8 — Activity: Intelligence Questions

For Foundry’s tool:

- Define 3 intelligence questions
 - Identify the data needed
 - Identify what to instrument
-

Slide 9 — Debrief

Ask:

“Where in the intelligence loop does your team break down?”

Slide 10 — Internal Product Design

- Research with engineers
 - Dogfooding ≠ research
 - Real testing > assumptions
 - Investment rationale matters
-

Slide 11 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“What internal tool would benefit most from a design review — and who must you convince?”

Slide 12 — Activity: Research Plan

Sketch a research plan for Foundry’s next internal tool:

- Who to speak to
 - What to observe
 - What to measure
 - What to test
-

Slide 13 — Close

One takeaway

One question

Next: SERVICE DESIGN.

Slide 14 — Further Reading & Resources

Books

- *The Developer Experience Book* — Matthew Skelton

Articles

- “Developer Experience: What It Is and Why It Matters” — GitHub
- “The Product Intelligence Loop” — Mixpanel

Talks

- Charity Majors — observability & internal tooling

Absolutely, Jacinta — here are **Modules 07, 08, and 09** in full **slide-ready format**, each ending with a **Further Reading & Resources** slide, all in your **Signature Jacinta tone**.

These are clean, scannable, deck-ready, and aligned with the Blueprinting pack style.

MODULE 07 — SERVICE DESIGN

Slide-Ready Deck (Signature Jacinta Style + Resources)

Slide 1 — Title

SERVICE DESIGN

Most experiences fail in the back stage, not the front.

Slide 2 — What This Module Is About

- Seeing the whole system
 - Blueprinting front + back stage
 - Identifying upstream causes
 - Prioritising tactical vs strategic fixes
 - Designing across channels, teams, and processes
-

Slide 3 — Opening Story

Meridian's mortgage app:

- 4.7 star rating
- Beautiful UI
- 38% drop-out at document upload
- Back stage still required fax

→ **The problem wasn't the screen. It was the system.**

Slide 4 — What Service Design Is

- Designing the *whole* experience
 - Across people, processes, policies, tech
 - Front stage + back stage
 - Making the invisible visible
-

Slide 5 — Five Problems Blueprinting Solves

- Upstream causes
 - Broken experiences
 - Backstage inefficiencies
 - Silo breakdowns
 - Fuzzy ownership
-

Slide 6 — Where Blueprinting Fits

Part of the journey map family:

- Journey map = customer experience
 - Blueprint = customer + system
 - Blueprint = truth serum
-

Slide 7 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“Name one step your customer sees — and what’s happening backstage to deliver it.”

Slide 8 — Anatomy of a Blueprint

Five lanes:

- Customer actions
- Front stage
- Back stage
- Support processes
- Systems

Three lines:

- Line of interaction
 - Line of visibility
 - Line of internal interaction
-

Slide 9 — Activity: Map the Front Stage

For Meridian's mortgage scenario:

- Identify steps
 - Identify emotions
 - Identify friction
 - Identify expectations
-

Slide 10 — Debrief

Ask:

“What did you assume was smooth that another lane showed was broken?”

Slide 11 — Diverge → Converge

Diverge:

- Capture everything

- No judgment

Converge:

- Cluster
 - Prioritise
 - Identify critical moments
-

Slide 12 — Mining the Blueprint

Look for:

- Breakpoints
 - Handoffs
 - Delays
 - Policy mismatches
 - Channel inconsistencies
 - Staff pain
-

Slide 13 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“Where does your front/back stage handoff most often fail?”

Slide 14 — Activity: Add Back Stage

Add:

- Back stage actions
- Support processes
- Systems
- Ownership

Identify:

- 1 tactical fix
- 1 strategic fix

Slide 15 — Close

One takeaway

One question

Next: INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE.

Slide 16 — Further Reading & Resources

Books

- *This Is Service Design Doing* — Stickdorn et al.
- *Service Design: From Insight to Implementation* — Polaine, Løvlie, Reason

Articles

- NN/g: “Service Blueprinting 101”

Talks

- Lou Downe — “Good Services”

Primary Resource

- Your **Service Blueprinting Pack** (core teaching asset)
-

MODULE 08 — INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

Slide-Ready Deck (Signature Jacinta Style + Resources)

Slide 1 — Title

INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

Structure is invisible until it breaks.

Slide 2 — What This Module Is About

- Designing structure
- Mental models
- Navigation principles
- Card sorting + tree testing
- Agent-era IA (delegation, not navigation)

Slide 3 — Opening Story

Orbit added 400 new titles.

Engagement dropped.

The content was there — the structure wasn't.

→ **IA is the quiet discipline that makes everything else feel effortless.**

Slide 4 — What IA Is

- Organisation
- Labelling
- Navigation
- Search

IA = how people find what they need.

Slide 5 — Mental Models

- Users bring expectations
 - Systems must match them
 - Misaligned models = friction
-

Slide 6 — Classical IA Methods

- Card sorting (open vs closed)
 - Tree testing
 - Navigation design
 - Label testing
-

Slide 7 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“Name a product where the navigation just works — and one where it absolutely doesn’t.”

Slide 8 — Activity: Card Sort

Sort 24 Orbit features:

- Open sort
 - Name categories
 - Compare with a partner
-

Slide 9 — Debrief

Ask:

“Where did you disagree — and what does that reveal about mental models?”

Slide 10 — Agent-Era IA

When users delegate instead of navigate:

- Visibility
 - Interruption
 - Trust
 - Control
-

Slide 11 — Interruption Model

Design when the agent:

- Pauses
 - Asks
 - Explains
 - Hands back control
-

Slide 12 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“For Foundry’s deployment agent — what are the three moments it must interrupt the engineer?”

Slide 13 — Activity: Design the Interruption Model

Map:

- Trigger
 - Agent action
 - User action
 - Copy
 - Recovery
-

Slide 14 — Close

One takeaway

One question

Next: CONVERSATIONAL UI.

Slide 15 — Further Reading & Resources

Books

- *Information Architecture for the Web and Beyond* — Rosenfeld, Morville, Arango
- *Everyday Information Architecture* — Lisa Maria Marquis

Articles

- NN/g: “Card Sorting: When, Why, How”
- Google UX: “Designing for Agents”

Talks

- Abby Covert — “How to Make Sense of Any Mess”

★ MODULE 09 — CONVERSATIONAL UI

Slide-Ready Deck (Signature Jacinta Style + Resources)

Slide 1 — Title

CONVERSATIONAL UI

When there's no button to press, language is the design.

Slide 2 — What This Module Is About

- Dialogue design
 - Tone as interface
 - Conversation flows
 - Error recovery
 - Disclosure in high-stakes contexts
-

Slide 3 — Opening Story

Luma Health launched a chatbot.
Technically correct.

Emotionally off.
60% drop-off after the second response.

→ **Language *is* the interface.**

Slide 4 — When Conversation UI Works

- High ambiguity
 - High emotion
 - High context
 - Low complexity tasks
-

Slide 5 — Dialogue Design Principles

- Turn-taking
 - Response length
 - Reading level
 - Persona
 - Predictability
-

Slide 6 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“Have you ever spoken to an AI that felt natural? What made it feel that way?”

Slide 7 — Conversation Flow Design

- Happy path
 - Branching
 - Unexpected inputs
 - Error recovery
 - Fallbacks
-

Slide 8 — Activity: Write a Flow

For a patient asking about medication dose:

- Happy path
 - One branch
 - One fallback
-

Slide 9 — Debrief

Ask:

“Where did your dialogue break — and how did you design your way out?”

Slide 10 — Persona Design

Define:

- Voice
 - Tone
 - Character
 - Boundaries
 - Disclosure rules
-

Slide 11 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“When should Luma’s bot disclose it’s AI — and how should it say it?”

Slide 12 — Activity: Error States

Design 3 error states + 3 recovery responses:

- Clear
- Human
- Non-defensive

- Actionable
-

Slide 13 — Close

One takeaway

One question

Next: AI-ERA DESIGN.

Slide 14 — Further Reading & Resources

Books

- *Designing Voice User Interfaces* — Cathy Pearl
- *Conversational Design* — Erika Hall

Articles

- Google: “Principles of Bot Design”

Talks

- Erika Hall — “Designing for Conversation”

Podcasts

- Voicebot.ai
-

Absolutely, Jacinta — here is the **final batch**, covering **Modules 10, 11, and 12**, in full **slide-ready format**, each ending with a **Further Reading & Resources** slide.

After this, we’ll finish with **Module 13** to complete the entire deck set.

Let’s go.

MODULE 10 — AI-ERA DESIGN

Slide 1 — Title

AI-ERA DESIGN

AI changes what we build. It doesn't change why.

Slide 2 — What This Module Is About

- Designing for probabilistic systems
 - Communicating uncertainty
 - Building trust
 - AI → human handoffs
 - Ethical design considerations
-

Slide 3 — Opening Story

Meridian's AI loan advisor:

- 87% accurate
- 13% failure
- Errors surfaced weeks later
- Another team dealt with the fallout

→ **AI errors are system errors.**

Slide 4 — What Changes With AI

- Outputs are probabilistic
 - Confidence varies
 - Reasoning is opaque
 - Errors compound
 - Trust becomes the interface
-

Slide 5 — Transparency Spectrum

From:

- Black box

To:

- Explainable AI

Design choices:

- What to show
 - What to hide
 - When to reveal
-

Slide 6 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“Name a product that uses AI — does it tell you when it’s uncertain?”

Slide 7 — Confidence UI

Design for:

- Uncertainty
 - Ranges
 - Confidence levels
 - “Best guess” vs “certain”
-

Slide 8 — Activity: Trust Signal

Design a trust signal for the loan rate recommendation:

- What do you show?
- What do you not show?
- How do you phrase it?

Slide 9 — Debrief

Ask:

“What did you choose to show — and what did you choose to hide?”

Slide 10 — Trust Patterns

- Progressive disclosure
 - Reasoning previews
 - Graceful failure
 - Human handoff moments
 - Audit trails
-

Slide 11 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“In Meridian’s advisor — who is responsible when the AI is wrong?”

Slide 12 — Activity: Map the Handoff

Map:

- When AI acts
 - When AI pauses
 - When AI asks
 - When AI hands back control
-

Slide 13 — Ethical Design

Consider:

- Bias

- Accessibility
 - Incomplete data
 - Over-trust
 - Under-trust
-

Slide 14 — Close

One takeaway

One question

Next: DATA & DECISIONS.

Slide 15 — Further Reading & Resources

Books

- *Human-Centered AI* — Ben Shneiderman
- *The Alignment Problem* — Brian Christian

Articles

- IBM: “Explainable AI for Designers”
- Google: “Confidence UI Patterns”

Talks

- Josh Clark — “Designing for AI”
-

MODULE 11 — DATA & DECISIONS

Slide-Ready Deck (Signature Jacinta Style + Resources)

Slide 1 — Title

DATA & DECISIONS

Leaders don't need more data. They need to trust the data they have.

Slide 2 — What This Module Is About

- Information design
- Dashboard clarity
- Data quality as UX
- Communicating uncertainty
- Designing for decision-making

Slide 3 — Opening Story

Meridian's execs meet weekly with a **47-slide data pack**.
Decisions still get made on gut feel.

→ **More data ≠ better decisions.**

Slide 4 — What Leaders Actually Need

- Signal
- Context
- Confidence
- Anomaly detection
- A clear "so what?"

Slide 5 — Dashboard Design Principles

- Hierarchy
 - Primary metric
 - Supporting metrics
 - Trends
 - Anomalies
 - Clear labels
-

Slide 6 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“What dashboard do you use — and what decision does it actually help you make?”

Slide 7 — Data Quality as UX

Design for:

- Recency
 - Methodology
 - Uncertainty
 - Trust signals
 - Data lineage
-

Slide 8 — Activity: Critique the Dashboard

For Meridian’s dashboard:

- Identify noise
 - Identify signal
 - Identify missing context
-

Slide 9 — Debrief

Ask:

“What’s the one number that actually matters for the decision?”

Slide 10 — AI-Generated Insights

Design for:

- Confidence
- Reasoning
- “So what?” layer

- Actionability
-

Slide 11 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“What metric does your leadership team consistently misread — and why?”

Slide 12 — Activity: Redesign a Panel

Redesign one panel to support one decision:

- What’s the decision?
 - What’s the signal?
 - What’s the context?
-

Slide 13 — Close

One takeaway

One question

Next: JUDGMENT IN PRACTICE.

Slide 14 — Further Reading & Resources

Books

- *The Visual Display of Quantitative Information* — Edward Tufte
- *Storytelling with Data* — Cole Nussbaumer Knaflic

Articles

- NN/g: “Dashboard Design Principles”

Talks

- David McCandless — “The Beauty of Data Visualization”

Podcasts

- Data Stories
-

MODULE 12 — JUDGMENT IN PRACTICE

Slide-Ready Deck (Signature Jacinta Style + Resources)

Slide 1 — Title

JUDGMENT IN PRACTICE

Tools matter. Judgment decides.

Slide 2 — What This Module Is About

- Decision hygiene
 - Forces that shape judgment
 - Judgment traps
 - Principled decision-making
 - Writing decision briefs
-

Slide 3 — Opening Story

A Meridian team had:

- Perfect research
- Clear insight
- Validated concept

They still shipped the wrong thing because the loudest stakeholder won.

→ **Judgment is the real work.**

Slide 4 — Judgment as a Practice

Good judgment requires:

- Clarity
- Courage
- Curiosity
- Constraint awareness

Slide 5 — Four Forces That Shape Judgment

- Incentives
- Evidence
- Emotion
- Power

These forces shape every decision.

Slide 6 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“Which of these four forces shapes decisions most in your organisation?”

Slide 7 — Decision Hygiene

Separate:

- Facts
 - Interpretations
 - Assumptions
 - Preferences
 - Principles
-

Slide 8 — Activity: Reconstruct a Decision

For a past decision:

- What was known?
 - Unknown?
 - Assumed?
 - Feared?
 - Incentivised?
-

Slide 9 — Debrief

Ask:

“What changed when you separated fact from interpretation?”

Slide 10 — Judgment Traps

- Premature convergence
 - Overconfidence
 - Consensus theatre
 - Analysis paralysis
-

Slide 11 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“Which trap does your team fall into most often?”

Slide 12 — Activity: Write a Decision Brief

Include:

- The decision
- The evidence
- The risks

- The trade-offs
 - The principle guiding the choice
-

Slide 13 — Close

One takeaway

One question

Next: CAPSTONE / INTEGRATION.

Slide 14 — Further Reading & Resources

Books

- *Noise* — Kahneman, Sibony, Sunstein
- *Thinking in Bets* — Annie Duke
- *The Art of Thinking Clearly* — Rolf Dobelli

Articles

- “Decision Hygiene” — Olivier Sibony

Talks

- Annie Duke — “How to Decide”
-

Beautiful — here is your **Module 13** slide-ready deck, completing the entire curriculum set.

Signature Jacinta tone.

Clean, scannable slides.

Final slide includes curated resources.

Let’s close this program with the energy it deserves.

★ MODULE 13 — CAPSTONE / INTEGRATION

Slide-Ready Deck (Signature Jacinta Style + Resources)

Slide 1 — Title

CAPSTONE / INTEGRATION

Design is a discipline. Integration is the skill.

Slide 2 — What This Module Is About

- Bringing all disciplines together
 - Running the Design-Led Loop
 - Cross-discipline synthesis
 - Solving real organisational problems
 - Designing your ongoing practice
-

Slide 3 — Opening Story

Three Meridian teams tackled the same problem.

- Team A used research
- Team B used strategy
- Team C integrated across disciplines

Only Team C solved the root cause.

Slide 4 — The Integration Challenge

Design-Led =

Research → Insight → Strategy → Product → Service → Data → Judgment

Most teams:

- Over-index on one discipline
- Skip steps under pressure
- Lose the thread

Integration is the differentiator.

Slide 5 — The Design-Led Loop

A repeatable pattern:

1. Frame
 2. Learn
 3. Make sense
 4. Decide
 5. Design
 6. Test
 7. Integrate
 8. Repeat
-

Slide 6 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“Which part of the loop is your team strongest in — and which part do you skip?”

Slide 7 — Cross-Discipline Synthesis

Combine:

- Evidence
- Opportunity
- Feasibility
- Risk
- Judgment

Synthesis = where the magic happens.

Slide 8 — Activity: Capstone Challenge

Choose a real organisational problem.

Run a compressed version of the loop:

- Frame
- Learn
- Analyse
- Strategise
- Design
- Test
- Recommend

Slide 9 — Debrief

Ask:

“Where did your team get stuck — and what unlocked it?”

Look for:

- Missing evidence
- Misaligned incentives
- Hidden constraints
- Unspoken assumptions

Slide 10 — Designing Your Practice

Build rituals that sustain Design-Led:

- Weekly research
- Insight reviews
- Decision briefs
- Blueprinting sessions
- OST updates
- Data check-ins

Rituals → culture.

Slide 11 — Quick Hit

Prompt:

“What’s one ritual you’ll take back to your team next week?”

Slide 12 — Activity: Your Operating Manual

Write your Design-Led operating manual:

- Principles
 - Rituals
 - Methods
 - Commitments
 - Anti-patterns to avoid
-

Slide 13 — Close

One takeaway

One commitment

One next step

You now have the full Design-Led toolkit.

Slide 14 — Further Reading & Resources

Books

- *Range* — David Epstein
- *Systems Thinking for Social Change* — David Peter Stroh

Articles

- “The Double Diamond Isn’t Enough” — Dan Nessler

Talks

- Roger Martin — “The Power of Integrative Thinking”

Podcasts

- Farnam Street — multidisciplinary thinking
-

Absolutely, Jacinta — let’s build the **Design-Led Participant Workbook**.

This will be:

- A **clean, structured, fillable workbook**
- One section per module
- Prompts, exercises, reflection questions
- Space for notes, sketches, decisions
- Written in your **Signature Jacinta tone**
- Zero fluff, zero jargon
- Designed so participants can print it, annotate it, or use it digitally

Below is **Part 1 of the Workbook (Modules 01–04)**.

Once you confirm the structure feels right, I’ll continue with **Modules 05–13**.

DESIGN-LED PARTICIPANT WORKBOOK

Modules 01–04

Warm clarity with a backbone. Grounded. Human. Commercially fluent.

MODULE 01 — FOUNDATIONS

Design is the discipline of making good decisions.

1.1 — Your Current Definition of Design

Write your own definition of design *before* the module begins.

Prompt:

What do you think design *is* today?

Your answer:

1.2 — The Three Lenses Audit

Choose a recent project and score it across the three lenses.

Project: _____

Lens	Score (1–5)	Notes
Desirable	_____	_____ —
Viable	_____	_____ —
Feasible	_____	_____ —

Where did you over-index?

Where did you skip?

1.3 — Mindset Reflection

Which design mindset is hardest for you to practise?

- Empathy first
- Systems thinking
- Bias to action
- Embrace ambiguity
- Iterate always
- Communicate intent

Why this one?

1.4 — Reframing the Brief

Rewrite the Meridian Bank brief.

Original brief:

“Fix the onboarding drop-off.”

Better question:

1.5 — Your Takeaway

What’s the one idea from this module you want to carry forward?

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MODULE 02 — RESEARCH

The most expensive thing you can build is the wrong thing.

2.1 — Your Research Habits

How often does your team talk to users?

- Weekly
- Fortnightly
- Monthly
- Rarely
- Never

What gets in the way?

2.2 — Assumption Dump

List 5 assumptions your team is currently making.

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

Which one feels riskiest? Why?

2.3 — Write Better Questions

Rewrite these questions to remove solutions and bias:

Bad question:

“Would you use a reminder feature if we added it?”

Your rewrite:

Bad question:

“Do you find the app confusing?”

Your rewrite:

Bad question:

“Would you prefer Option A or B?”

Your rewrite:

2.4 — Emotional + Contextual Probes

Write one emotional probe and one contextual probe for your product.

Emotional probe:

Contextual probe:

2.5 — Bias Reflection

Which bias affects your team most?

- Hawthorn
- Availability
- Incentives
- Note-taking
- Novice/Expert
- Telescope
- Primacy

Example from your work:

2.6 — Your Takeaway

What's the one research habit you want to build?

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MODULE 03 — ANALYSIS

Data doesn't speak for itself. Someone has to make sense of it.

3.1 — Your Analysis Reality Check

What usually happens to research in your team?

- We analyse it properly
- We skim it
- We skip it
- We rely on gut
- We pretend we analysed it

Why?

3.2 — Affinity Mapping Practice

Cluster these three example quotes into themes:

Quote A:

"I always forget where to upload documents."

Quote B:

"I'm not sure what happens after I submit."

Quote C:

"I don't trust the status updates."

Your clusters:

Cluster names (what they *tell you*):

3.3 — Insight Writing

Turn one cluster into an insight.

Insight formula:

A deep truth about behaviour that explains *why* something is happening.

Your insight:

3.4 — HMW Reframing

Turn your insight into a How Might We.

HMW:

3.5 — Prioritisation

Which HMW opens the most opportunity?

3.6 — Your Takeaway

What's the one analysis practice you want to strengthen?

<div style="page-break-after: always;"></div>

MODULE 04 — STRATEGY

Good design decisions are also good business decisions.

4.1 — Business Model Snapshot

Sketch the business model of your product.

Customer segments:

Value proposition:

Revenue model:

Key costs:

4.2 — Value Proposition Canvas

Fill in the core elements:

Customer jobs:

Pains:

Gains:

Pain relievers:

Gain creators:

4.3 — Jobs to Be Done

What job is your product hired to do?

Functional job:

Emotional job:

Social job:

4.4 — Strategy Gap Check

Where is your product weakest?

- Job clarity
- Value proposition
- Business model
- Customer understanding
- Market fit

Why?

4.5 — One-Page Recommendation

Draft your strategic recommendation:

- The job
- The opportunity
- The commercial rationale
- The design direction

Your draft:

4.6 — Your Takeaway

What's the one strategic lens you want to use more often?
